

Ben Botsford

Site Reliability Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability Engineer with 3 years of experience designing and operating distributed systems in on-premises datacenters and GCP. Expertise in Kubernetes, Confluent Kafka, and CI/CD automation across Linux and Windows environments. Proven track record reducing deployment friction, leading incident response, and onboarding engineering teams onto complex infrastructure. Background spanning software development and education gives a unique ability to bridge the gap between platform teams and application developers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm

Streaming & Messaging: Apache Kafka (Confluent)

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible

CI/CD & Automation: Jenkins, GitHub Actions

Cloud Computing: GCP, GKE

Observability: Splunk, DataDog

Languages & Frameworks: Python, JavaScript, SQL, Django, Flask, React

EXPERIENCE

Surescripts

Senior Site Reliability Engineer, August 2026 – Present

Site Reliability Engineer, July 2023 – August 2026

- Architect and operate GCP-based infrastructure supporting distributed, high-throughput services across Kubernetes clusters; reduced deployment times and improved availability through ArgoCD-driven GitOps workflows.
- Serve as subject matter expert for Confluent Kafka, leading developer onboarding, managing cluster configuration, and owning operational playbooks for consumer lag, topic management, and application integration patterns.
- Automate infrastructure provisioning and configuration across Windows and Linux environments using Terraform and Ansible, improving consistency and reducing manual labor across the stack.
- Participate in 24/7 on-call rotation, leading incident triage and resolution for production issues; contribute to blameless post-mortems and implement code and configuration changes to reduce MTTR.
- Mentor application developers on infrastructure best practices, CI/CD pipelines, and Kubernetes deployment patterns, accelerating team onboarding and reducing dependency on the platform team.
- Partner cross-functionally with software and platform engineers to drive integration of new services into Jenkins-based CI/CD pipelines, improving deployment reliability across dozens of services.

Flatiron School

Senior Python Curriculum Developer, March 2022 – May 2023

- Designed and maintained technical curriculum used by thousands of students nationwide covering core software engineering: version control, data structures and algorithms, backend development with Python/Flask and SQLAlchemy, and front-end design with JavaScript/React.
- Collaborated with instructors and instructional designers to ensure technical accuracy, effective pedagogy, and alignment with evolving industry standards in Python, JavaScript, SQL, and web frameworks.

The University of Texas at Austin, Pflugerville ISD

Teaching Specialist / Biology Teacher, January 2019 – March 2022

- Led labs and discussion-based instruction for Introductory Biology, Human Health & Disease, and Human Systems Physiology, providing structured lessons and detailed feedback to hundreds of students per term.
- Taught Biology and Pre-AP Biology at a Title I high school.

The University of Texas at Austin

Software Engineer, June 2016 – August 2018

Software Developer, November 2015 – June 2016

- Supported authentication workflows, access provisioning, and account lifecycle management across multiple platforms and user tiers at scale.
- Worked with enterprise identity tooling including SAML, Duo MFA, and ForgeRock.
- Designed and delivered web applications using Django and RESTful APIs via MuleSoft/CloudHub, contributing to high-impact tools used across the institution.
- Identified architectural and performance improvements in legacy systems, implementing targeted enhancements ahead of schedule as a developer.

Socrates Analytics

Software Developer, May 2014 – March 2015

Software Developer Intern, June 2013 – May 2014

- Contributed to an early-stage electronic health record application with predictive analytics suite, using Python, Django, MySQL, and R to build and optimize features for hospital and skilled nursing facility users.

EDUCATION

B.A., Cognitive Science • Case Western Reserve University • 2014